



Basant Rajan
Chief Technology Officer
Symantec Corporation, India

Blogging is a great tool for communication and collaboration. It can be used by domain experts to communicate with customers and the world at large, as we do with the Symantec security Weblog. It can also be used by employees to collaborate as we do with our internal blog. Then, most employees at Symantec use wikis or Microsoft SharePoint for collaboration within or across groups.

Social networking sites help our employees keep in touch with individuals or groups both inside and outside the company, and to continue to make new and useful contacts that will ultimately help them in being more productive.

Web 2.0 technologies are very productive when used appropriately, but as with any technology, there is always the possibility of misuse. It would be prudent to be watchful, and we are. There are a number of policies that govern the exchange of information and the monitoring thereof.

Still, our employees enjoy considerable flexibility in terms of how they use their computers, the Internet, and the intranet. Everything we do at Symantec is ultimately about enabling people to work and play freely in a connected world.



WEB 2.0 AND

From a business perspective, is blogging and social networking of any value—to a company? Should employees be *encouraged* to indulge in these “Web 2.0 activities”?



Santosh D'Souza
Chief Technology Officer
Sun Microsystems, India

The goal of providing a blog-space for employees has been to ensure that people become part of conversations occurring around the industry. Sun employees, through their blog posts, are now participating in dialogues, be they about technology or otherwise, in a way that transcends geography and time.

Sun's effectiveness at knowing what its community is saying has been improved immensely by the blogging process. Blogs serve as a good tool for internal communication as well. For the top management, blogging can be a powerful and highly credible tool to communicate with employees. Blogging serves as an effective tool to attract talent. With companies vying with each other to attract the best talent, we have to prove we are a more vibrant, interesting, and open company. These blogs reflect the quality of the people and that's the quality of the company. Blogs have authenticated the Sun brand as much as or more than a billion-dollar ad campaign could have done.

Blogging allows employees to get to know each other better, to gain a broader understanding of their co-workers.

Sun has embraced other Web 2.0 means, like YouTube videos, podcasts, and Second Life, to get the message across about our solutions.